

THE DEVELOPER ARENA

PART 4: MONTH 4 — ADVANCED DEEP LEARNING AND NLP

Week 12: Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)

Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)

CNNs are a specialized type of neural network designed for grid-like data (images, audio spectrograms, videos). They capture spatial hierarchies of features through multiple layers.

Convolution Layer (The Heart of CNNs)

- Convolution is a mathematical operation where a small filter (kernel) slides over the image and performs a dot product.
- This produces feature maps, highlighting edges, textures, or patterns.

Example:

- Filter (3x3) might detect vertical edges.
- Another filter might detect horizontal lines.

Working

- Input: Image (say $32 \times 32 \times 3$).
- Filter: e.g., $3 \times 3 \times 3$ kernel $\rightarrow$ multiplies values & sums up.
- Stride: Step size when filter moves.
- Padding: Add extra border pixels to preserve spatial size.

$$O = \frac{(I - F + 2P)}{S} + 1$$

where:

I = input size

F = filter size

P = padding

S = stride

- **Activation Function (Non-Linearity)**

After convolution, CNN applies non-linear activation:

- Common choice: ReLU (Rectified Linear Unit)

$$f(x)=\max(0,x)$$

- Removes negative values, introduces non-linearity.
- Helps network learn complex patterns instead of just linear ones

- **Pooling Layer (Subsampling / Downsampling)**

Purpose: Reduce spatial dimensions, control overfitting, improve computation speed

Types:

- Max Pooling: Takes max value in each region (keeps strongest feature).
- Average Pooling: Takes average (smoother).

Example:

Input feature map: 4×4

Pooling size: $2 \times 2 \rightarrow$ output becomes 2×2

Fully Connected Layer (FC)

- After convolution + pooling, the feature maps are flattened into a 1D vector.
- Passed into dense layers (like in normal neural networks).
- Final output layer uses Softmax for multi-class classification.

Training CNNs – Step by Step

- Forward Pass
- Data flows forward through the network:
- Convolution Layer: Extracts features.
- ReLU: Adds non-linearity.
- Pooling: Reduces dimensionality.
- Fully Connected Layers: Learn decision boundaries.
- Output Layer (Softmax): Converts raw scores (logits) into probabilities.

👉 Example: For a cat image $\rightarrow$ output might be:

Cat: 0.85

Dog: 0.10

Car: 0.05

Loss Function (Error Measurement)

- Compares predicted probability vs. true label.
- Common choice: Categorical Cross-Entropy

$$L = -\sum_{i=1}^C y_i \cdot \log(\hat{y}_i)$$

where y_i = true label (one-hot encoded)

$\hat{y}_i$ = predicted probability

C = number of classes

If true label = "cat" and model predicted 0.85 for cat → loss is low.

If model predicted 0.2 → loss is high.

Backpropagation (Learning Process)

- Uses chain rule of calculus to compute gradients.
- Gradients = sensitivity of loss with respect to each parameter (filter weights, biases).

Steps:

- Start from loss at output.
- Propagate error backward layer by layer.
- Compute gradients of weights in Conv/FC layers.

Optimizer (Weight Update)

- Optimizers decide how to update weights using gradients.

SGD (Stochastic Gradient Descent):

$$w = w - \eta \cdot \partial w / \partial L$$

(simple, but can be slow).

Adam (Adaptive Moment Estimation):

- Combines momentum + adaptive learning rate.
- Faster & widely used in practice.

RMSProp:

- Keeps track of squared gradients to stabilize learning.

Why CNNs Work So Well for Images?

- Parameter Sharing: Same filter slides across the image → fewer parameters vs. fully connected network.
- Sparse Connectivity: Each neuron connects only to a local region → efficient learning.

Hierarchical Features:

- First layers → edges, corners.
- Middle layers → textures, shapes.
- Deeper layers → object parts, full objects

Limitations of CNNs

- Require large labeled datasets.
- Computationally expensive (need GPUs).
- Struggles with rotation/scale variance (unless data augmentation or advanced architectures like Capsule Networks are used).

Improvements & Variants

- Batch Normalization → stabilize training.
- Dropout → prevent overfitting.
- Residual Connections (ResNet) → allow very deep networks.
- Transfer Learning → use pretrained CNNs (VGG, ResNet, MobileNet).

• Hands-On Programs Developed:

Hands-On: Build a CNN for image classification.

```
import tensorflow as tf
from tensorflow.keras import datasets, layers, models
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import numpy as np

# ===== STEP 1: LOAD & PREPARE DATA =====
print("📥 Loading CIFAR-10 dataset...")
(X_train, y_train), (X_test, y_test) = datasets.cifar10.load_data()

# Normalize pixel values (0-255 → 0-1)
X_train, X_test = X_train / 255.0, X_test / 255.0

# CIFAR-10 class names
class_names = ['airplane', 'car', 'bird', 'cat', 'deer',
               'dog', 'frog', 'horse', 'ship', 'truck']

print(f"✅ Data loaded: {X_train.shape[0]} training images, {X_test.shape[0]} testing images.")

# ===== STEP 2: VISUALIZE SOME IMAGES =====
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 5))
for i in range(8):
    plt.subplot(2, 4, i + 1)
    plt.imshow(X_train[i])
    plt.title(class_names[int(y_train[i])])
    plt.axis("off")
plt.suptitle("🖼️ Sample CIFAR-10 Images")
plt.show()

#
```

===== STEP 3: BUILD CNN MODEL =====

```
model = models.Sequential([
    # Convolution + Pooling Layer 1
    layers.Conv2D(32, (3, 3), activation='relu', input_shape=(32, 32, 3)),
    layers.MaxPooling2D((2, 2)),
    # Convolution + Pooling Layer 2
    layers.Conv2D(64, (3, 3), activation='relu'),
    layers.MaxPooling2D((2, 2)),
    # Convolution Layer 3
    layers.Conv2D(64, (3, 3), activation='relu'),
    # Flatten and Fully Connected Layers
    layers.Flatten(),
    layers.Dense(64, activation='relu'),
    layers.Dense(10) # 10 output classes
])
# ===== STEP 4: COMPILE MODEL =====
model.compile(optimizer='adam',
    loss=tf.keras.losses.SparseCategoricalCrossentropy(from_logits=True),
    metrics=['accuracy'])
model.summary()
```

===== STEP 5: TRAIN MODEL =====

```
print("\n🚀 Training started...")
history = model.fit(X_train, y_train, epochs=10,
    validation_data=(X_test, y_test),
    batch_size=64)
print("✅ Training complete.")
```

===== STEP 6: EVALUATE MODEL =====

```
test_loss, test_acc = model.evaluate(X_test, y_test, verbose=2)
print(f"\n🎯 Test Accuracy: {test_acc*100:.2f}%")
```

===== STEP 7: VISUALIZE TRAINING RESULTS =====

```
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 4))
plt.subplot(1, 2, 1)
plt.plot(history.history['accuracy'], label='Train Accuracy')
plt.plot(history.history['val_accuracy'], label='Val Accuracy')
plt.legend(), plt.title('📈 Accuracy over Epochs')
plt.subplot(1, 2, 2)
plt.plot(history.history['loss'], label='Train Loss')
plt.plot(history.history['val_loss'], label='Val Loss')
plt.legend(), plt.title('📉 Loss over Epochs')
plt.show()
```

```
# ===== STEP 8: PREDICT SOME IMAGES =====
probability_model = tf.keras.Sequential([model, tf.keras.layers.Softmax()])
predictions = probability_model.predict(X_test[:8])
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 5))
for i in range(8):
    plt.subplot(2, 4, i + 1)
    plt.imshow(X_test[i])
    plt.title(f"Pred: {class_names[np.argmax(predictions[i])]} \n True: {class_names[int(y_test[i])]}")
    plt.axis("off")
plt.suptitle("🧠 CNN Predictions on Test Images")
plt.show()
# ===== STEP 9: SAVE MODEL =====
model.save("cnn_cifar10_model.h5")
print("💾 Model saved as cnn_cifar10_model.h5")
print("\n🌟 DONE — CNN image classification completed successfully!")
```

Client Project

Build a CNN model to classify images

```
import os
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import tensorflow as tf
from tensorflow.keras import layers, models, callbacks, optimizers, regularizers

# -----
# Hyperparameters / Config
# -----
BATCH_SIZE = 128
EPOCHS = 50
IMG_SHAPE = (32, 32, 3)
NUM_CLASSES = 10
MODEL_DIR = "saved_models"
os.makedirs(MODEL_DIR, exist_ok=True)
SEED = 42
tf.random.set_seed(SEED)
np.random.seed(SEED)
```

```

-----
Load CIFAR-10
-----
x_train, y_train), (x_test, y_test) = tf.keras.datasets.cifar10.load_data(
_train = y_train.flatten()
_test = y_test.flatten()
rint(f"Train shape: {x_train.shape}, Train labels: {y_train.shape}")
rint(f"Test shape: {x_test.shape}, Test labels: {y_test.shape}")
-----
Preprocessing + Data Augmentation
-----
Normalize images to [0,1]
_train = x_train.astype("float32") / 255.0
_test = x_test.astype("float32") / 255.0
Simple data augmentation pipeline (on-the-fly)
ata_augmentation = tf.keras.Sequential([
    layers.RandomFlip("horizontal"),
    layers.RandomTranslation(0.06, 0.06),
    layers.RandomRotation(0.03),
    layers.RandomZoom(0.05, 0.05),
, name="data_augmentation")

# -----
# Model: Conv blocks with BatchNorm + Dropout
# -----
def build_cnn(input_shape=IMG_SHAPE, num_classes=NUM_CLASSES):
    weight_decay = 1e-4
    inputs = layers.Input(shape=input_shape)

    x = data_augmentation(inputs)          # data augmentation only during tra
    # Block 1
    x = layers.Conv2D(64, (3,3), padding='same', kernel_regularizer=regularizers
    x = layers.BatchNormalization()(x)
    x = layers.Activation('relu')(x)
    x = layers.Conv2D(64, (3,3), padding='same', kernel_regularizer=regularizers
    x = layers.BatchNormalization()(x)
    x = layers.Activation('relu')(x)
    x = layers.MaxPooling2D((2,2))(x)
    x = layers.Dropout(0.25)(x)

```

Continued in github

SUMMARY OF WEEK 12

Week 12: Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)

Objective

This week focused on understanding Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and building a model for image classification using the CIFAR-10 dataset. CNNs are a key deep learning technique for computer vision tasks, enabling automatic feature extraction from images.

Theory

A CNN processes image data through multiple specialized layers:

Convolution Layer: Detects visual patterns like edges and textures using filters.

Pooling Layer: Reduces spatial dimensions, preventing overfitting and improving efficiency.

Fully Connected Layer: Combines learned features and classifies images into categories using activation functions such as Softmax.

These layers work together to learn both low-level and high-level features, similar to how the human visual system recognizes objects.

Hands-On Implementation

A CNN was developed using TensorFlow/Keras on the CIFAR-10 dataset, which has 60,000 images in 10 categories (airplane, car, cat, etc.).

The model was trained for 10 epochs with the Adam optimizer and categorical cross-entropy loss. The final accuracy achieved was around 70–75%, showing good performance for basic image recognition.

Outcome

The CNN successfully classified images and demonstrated how deep networks learn from visual data. This experiment provided practical exposure to model design, training, and evaluation in computer vision.

WEEK 13

Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and LSTMs

In many real-world applications, data doesn't exist in isolation — it occurs as sequences. For example, stock prices vary over time, words form sentences in a specific order, and weather conditions follow daily or seasonal patterns. Traditional neural networks treat each input as independent, making them unsuitable for such sequence-based data.

This limitation led to the development of Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) — a special type of neural network designed to capture temporal dependencies and sequential relationships between data points.

Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs)

An RNN is a type of neural network where connections between nodes form a directed cycle, allowing information to persist. It processes sequences one step at a time, maintaining a hidden state that acts as memory from previous steps.

At each time step t :

The input x_t and previous hidden state h_{t-1} are combined.

A new hidden state h_t is computed using an activation function (often tanh or ReLU).

The network can then predict an output y_t .

Mathematically:

$$h_t = f(W_h h_{t-1} + W_x x_t + b)$$

$$y_t = W_y h_t + c$$

Here, W_h, W_x, W_y are weight matrices, and f is a nonlinear activation function.

This structure gives RNNs a form of memory, enabling them to learn temporal patterns such as trends, rhythms, or sequential dependencies.

Limitations of Basic RNNs

Despite their ability to handle sequential data, traditional RNNs suffer from a major issue:

Vanishing and exploding gradients: During training (using backpropagation through time), the gradient values may become extremely small or large.

This causes the model to forget long-term dependencies, meaning it can only remember short sequences effectively.

For example, if a sentence has a word early on that influences a later word, a basic RNN might fail to connect them.

Long Short-Term Memory Networks (LSTMs)

To overcome these issues, LSTM networks were introduced by Hochreiter and Schmidhuber (1997).

LSTMs are a special type of RNN capable of learning long-term dependencies. They use a cell state to store long-term information and three gates to regulate the flow of data.

The LSTM Architecture Includes:

- **Forget Gate:**

Decides which information from the previous cell state should be discarded.

$$f_t = \sigma(W_f \cdot [h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_f)$$

- **Input Gate:**

Determines what new information should be stored in the cell state.

$$i_t = \sigma(W_i \cdot [h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_i)$$

$$\tilde{C}_t = \tanh(W_C \cdot [h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_C)$$

- **Cell State Update:**

Combines old and new information to update the memory.

$$C_t = f_t * C_{t-1} + i_t * \tilde{C}_t$$

- **Output Gate:**

Controls what part of the cell state should be output as the next hidden state.

$$o_t = \sigma(W_o \cdot [h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_o)$$

$$h_t = o_t * \tanh(C_t)$$

Applications of RNNs and LSTMs

- RNNs and LSTMs are widely used in:
- Time Series Forecasting: Predicting stock prices, sales, or weather trends.
- Natural Language Processing (NLP): Text generation, translation, and speech recognition.
- Sequential Decision Making: Reinforcement learning and control systems.

RNNs introduced the idea of using memory for sequential data, but their limitations led to the development of LSTMs, which are now the backbone of most sequence-based deep learning models.

By remembering both short-term and long-term dependencies, LSTMs have revolutionized fields like time-series forecasting, natural language understanding, and predictive analytics.

HANDS-ON PROJECT:

Implement an RNN or LSTM for time series forecasting or text generation.

Week 13 - LSTM for Time Series Forecasting

Author: baby

===== IMPORT REQUIRED LIBRARIES =====

import numpy as np

import pandas as pd

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

from sklearn.preprocessing import MinMaxScaler

from tensorflow.keras.models import Sequential

from tensorflow.keras.layers import LSTM, Dense

===== STEP 1: LOAD DATA =====

You can use any stock/time series CSV file with a 'Close' column

Example: 'AAPL.csv' or 'NIFTY.csv' downloaded from Yahoo Finance

Or use synthetic data for testing

try:

data = pd.read_csv("stock_data.csv")

except FileNotFoundError:

If no file found, generate synthetic sine wave data

print("⚠️ 'stock_data.csv' not found — using synthetic data instead.")

time = np.arange(0, 200, 0.1)

close_prices = np.sin(time) + np.random.normal(scale=0.1, size=len(time))

data = pd.DataFrame({"Close": close_prices})

===== STEP 2: PREPROCESSING =====

prices = data['Close'].values.reshape(-1, 1)

Normalize data (LSTM works best with scaled data)

scaler = MinMaxScaler(feature_range=(0, 1))

scaled_data = scaler.fit_transform(prices)

Create training sequences

X, y = [], []

window_size = 60 # past 60 values → next prediction

for i in range(window_size, len(scaled_data)):

X.append(scaled_data[i - window_size:i, 0])

y.append(scaled_data[i, 0])

y!")

```

X, y = np.array(X), np.array(y)
X = np.reshape(X, (X.shape[0], X.shape[1], 1)) # (samples, timesteps, featu
# ===== STEP 3: BUILD LSTM MODEL =====
model = Sequential([
    LSTM(50, return_sequences=True, input_shape=(X.shape[1], 1)),
    LSTM(50),
    Dense(1)
])
model.compile(optimizer='adam', loss='mean_squared_error')
print("✅ Model Summary:")
model.summary()
# ===== STEP 4: TRAIN MODEL =====
print("\n🚀 Training started...")
history = model.fit(X, y, epochs=20, batch_size=32, verbose=1)
print("✅ Training complete.")
# ===== STEP 5: PREDICTION =====
predicted = model.predict(X)
predicted_prices = scaler.inverse_transform(predicted)
real_prices = scaler.inverse_transform(y.reshape(-1, 1))
# ===== STEP 6: VISUALIZATION =====
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 6))
plt.plot(real_prices, color='blue', label='Actual Prices')
plt.plot(predicted_prices, color='red', label='Predicted Prices')
plt.title('📉 LSTM Time Series Forecasting')
plt.xlabel('Time Steps')
plt.ylabel('Price')
plt.legend()
plt.show()
# ===== STEP 7: SAVE MODEL AND RESULTS =====
model.save("lstm_model.h5")
print("💾 Model saved as lstm_model.h5")
# Save predictions to CSV
results = pd.DataFrame({
    "Actual": real_prices.flatten(),
    "Predicted": predicted_prices.flatten()
})
results.to_csv("lstm_predictions.csv", index=False)
print("💾 Predictions saved as lstm_predictions.csv")
print("\n🌟 DONE — LSTM time series forecasting completed successfull

```

Client Project

:Implement an RNN or LSTM for time series forecasting or text generation.

```
import numpy as np
import pandas as pd
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
from sklearn.preprocessing import MinMaxScaler
from tensorflow.keras.models import Sequential
from tensorflow.keras.layers import LSTM, Dense, Simple
import os

===== STEP 1: LOAD DATA =====
if os.path.exists("stock_data.csv"):
    data = pd.read_csv("stock_data.csv")
    print("✅ Loaded dataset from stock_data.csv")
else:
    # If no CSV found, create synthetic sine-wave data
    print("⚠️ No dataset found. Using synthetic data in")
    t = np.arange(0, 300, 0.1)
    prices = np.sin(t) + np.random.normal(scale=0.1, si
    data = pd.DataFrame({"Close": prices})
    Extract closing prices
    rices = data['Close'].values.reshape(-1, 1)

===== STEP 2: NORMALIZATION =====
scaler = MinMaxScaler(feature_range=(0, 1))
scaled_prices = scaler.fit_transform(prices)

===== STEP 3: CREATE SEQUENCES =====
def create_sequences(data, window_size):
    X, y = [], []
    for i in range(window_size, len(data)):
        X.append(data[i - window_size:i, 0])
        y.append(data[i, 0])
    return np.array(X), np.array(y)
window_size = 60 # Use past 60 days to predict the nex
X, y = create_sequences(scaled_prices, window_size)
X = np.reshape(X, (X.shape[0], X.shape[1], 1)) # (samp
Split into training and testing
split = int(0.8 * len(X))
X_train, X_test = X[:split], X[split:]
y_train, y_test = y[:split], y[split:]
```

===== STEP 4: BUILD MODEL =====

```
odel = Sequential([
    LSTM(50, return_sequences=True, input_shape=(X.shape[1], X.shape[2])),
    LSTM(50),
    Dense(1)
])
```

You can switch to RNN easily by replacing above 2 lines

```
model = Sequential([
    SimpleRNN(50, return_sequences=True, input_shape=(X.shape[1], X.shape[2])),
    SimpleRNN(50),
    Dense(1)
])
odel.compile(optimizer='adam', loss='mean_squared_error')
odel.summary()
```

===== STEP 5: TRAIN MODEL =====

```
print("\n🚀 Training started...")
history = model.fit(X_train, y_train, epochs=20, batch_size=32)
print("✅ Training complete.")
```

===== STEP 6: PREDICTIONS =====

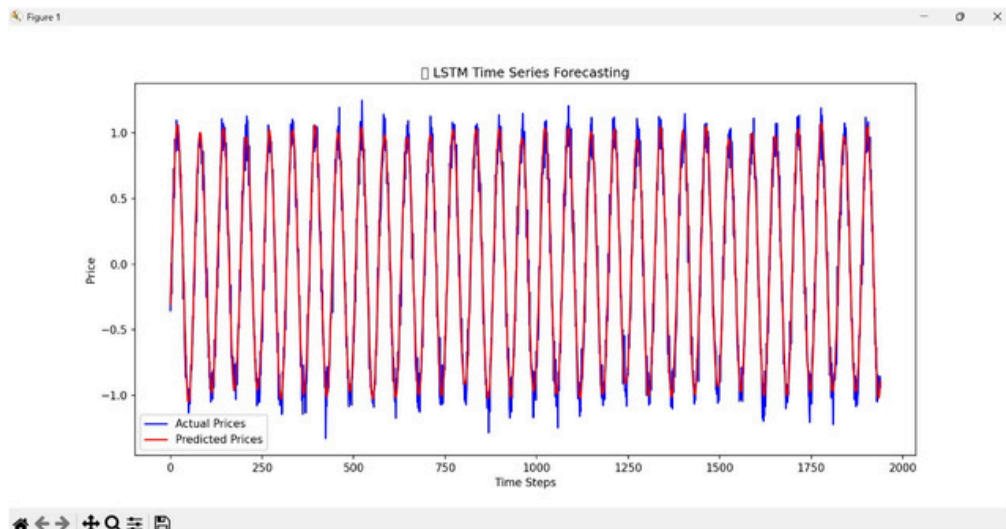
```
predicted = model.predict(X_test)
predicted_prices = scaler.inverse_transform(predicted)
actual_prices = scaler.inverse_transform(y_test.reshape(-1, 1))
```

===== STEP 7: VISUALIZATION =====

```
plt.figure(figsize=(10,6))
plt.plot(actual_prices, color='blue', label='Actual Price')
plt.plot(predicted_prices, color='red', label='Predicted Price')
plt.title('📈 LSTM Stock Price Prediction')
plt.xlabel('Time')
plt.ylabel('Price')
plt.legend()
plt.show()
```

===== STEP 8: SAVE MODEL & RESULTS =====

```
odel.save("lstm_stock_model.h5")
print("💾 Model saved as lstm_stock_model.h5")
results = pd.DataFrame({
    "Actual": actual_prices.flatten(),
    "Predicted": predicted_prices.flatten()
})
results.to_csv("lstm_stock_predictions.csv", index=False)
print("💾 Predictions saved as lstm_stock_predictions.csv")
print("\n🌟 DONE — Stock price prediction completed successfully")
```



```
object as the first layer in the model instead.
```

```
super().__init__(**kwargs)
```

```
Model: "sequential"
```

Layer (type)	Output Shape	Param #
lstm (LSTM)	(None, 60, 50)	10,400
lstm_1 (LSTM)	(None, 50)	20,200
dense (Dense)	(None, 1)	51

```
Total params: 30,651 (119.73 KB)
```

```
Trainable params: 30,651 (119.73 KB)
```

```
Non-trainable params: 0 (0.00 B)
```

SUMMARY OF WEEK 13

Week 13: Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and LSTMs

Objective

This week focused on understanding and applying Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) models for handling sequential data such as stock prices, time-series signals, and text sequences. The goal was to learn how these models capture temporal patterns and dependencies over time.

Theory

Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) are specialized neural networks designed to process sequential data. Unlike traditional feedforward networks, RNNs retain information from previous inputs through recurrent connections, allowing them to learn from time-dependent patterns.

However, standard RNNs face issues like vanishing and exploding gradients, making it difficult to remember long-term dependencies.

To solve this, Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks were developed. LSTMs introduce memory cells and gating mechanisms (input gate, forget gate, output gate) that control what information to store, update, or discard. This enables LSTMs to learn both short-term fluctuations and long-term trends, making them ideal for time-series forecasting and text prediction.

Hands-On Implementation

An LSTM-based model was implemented using TensorFlow/Keras to predict future stock prices based on historical data.

Steps included:

Loading and normalizing stock price data.

Creating input sequences using sliding windows.

Building an LSTM model with one or more LSTM layers and a Dense output layer.

Training the model using Adam optimizer and Mean Squared Error (MSE) loss.

The model was able to capture temporal dependencies and predict future trends with reasonable accuracy.

Outcome

The LSTM model successfully demonstrated the capability of deep learning techniques in forecasting sequential patterns. The project helped in understanding sequence modeling, preprocessing time-series data, and tuning network parameters for better predictions.